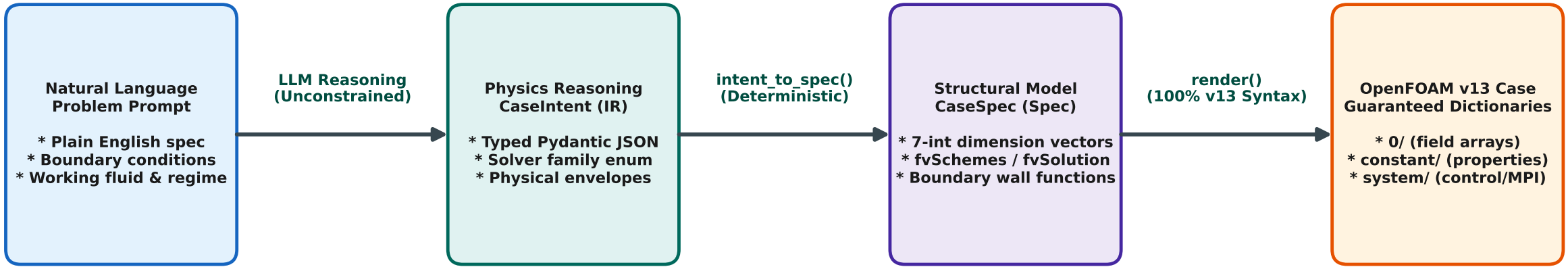The "Reason Free, Constrain Late" Paradigm: Decoupling Physics from Syntax